

Indian Independence Movement

AI Tutor - History - Lesson 3

Introduction

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Explanation

India was under British colonial rule for nearly 200 years. Growing economic hardship and a rising demand for self-governance fueled a broad independence movement through the early 20th century. Mahatma Gandhi led nonviolent resistance (Satyagraha), including the Salt March and the Quit India Movement. Jawaharlal Nehru, a key leader of the Indian National Congress, later became independent India's first Prime Minister, while Bhagat Singh represented the movement's more revolutionary strand. India gained independence on August 15, 1947, though the transition also led to the partition of British India into India and Pakistan.

Key Points

- Mahatma Gandhi led nonviolent resistance (Satyagraha), including the Salt March.
- Jawaharlal Nehru led the Indian National Congress and became India's first Prime Minister.
- Bhagat Singh represented the more revolutionary strand of the movement.
- India became independent on August 15, 1947.
- Independence was accompanied by the partition of India and Pakistan.

Examples

- The Salt March (1930) was a nonviolent protest against the British salt tax.
- The Quit India Movement (1942) demanded an end to British rule.

Summary

The Indian independence movement, led by figures like Gandhi (nonviolent resistance), Nehru, and Bhagat Singh, ended nearly 200 years of British rule on August 15, 1947, alongside the partition into India and Pakistan.

Practice Questions

- 1 What method of resistance did Mahatma Gandhi use?
- 2 On what date did India gain independence?
- 3 Name one leader associated with the revolutionary strand of the movement.

Quiz

Q1. What nonviolent method of resistance is associated with Mahatma Gandhi?

a) Guerrilla warfare | b) Satyagraha | c) Diplomacy | d) Armed rebellion

Q2. Who became India's first Prime Minister after independence?

a) Mahatma Gandhi | b) Bhagat Singh | c) Jawaharlal Nehru | d) Lord Mountbatten

Q3. On what date did India gain independence?

a) January 26, 1950 | b) August 15, 1947 | c) October 2, 1869 | d) March 12, 1930